

A Practical Approach to Family and Religious Studies

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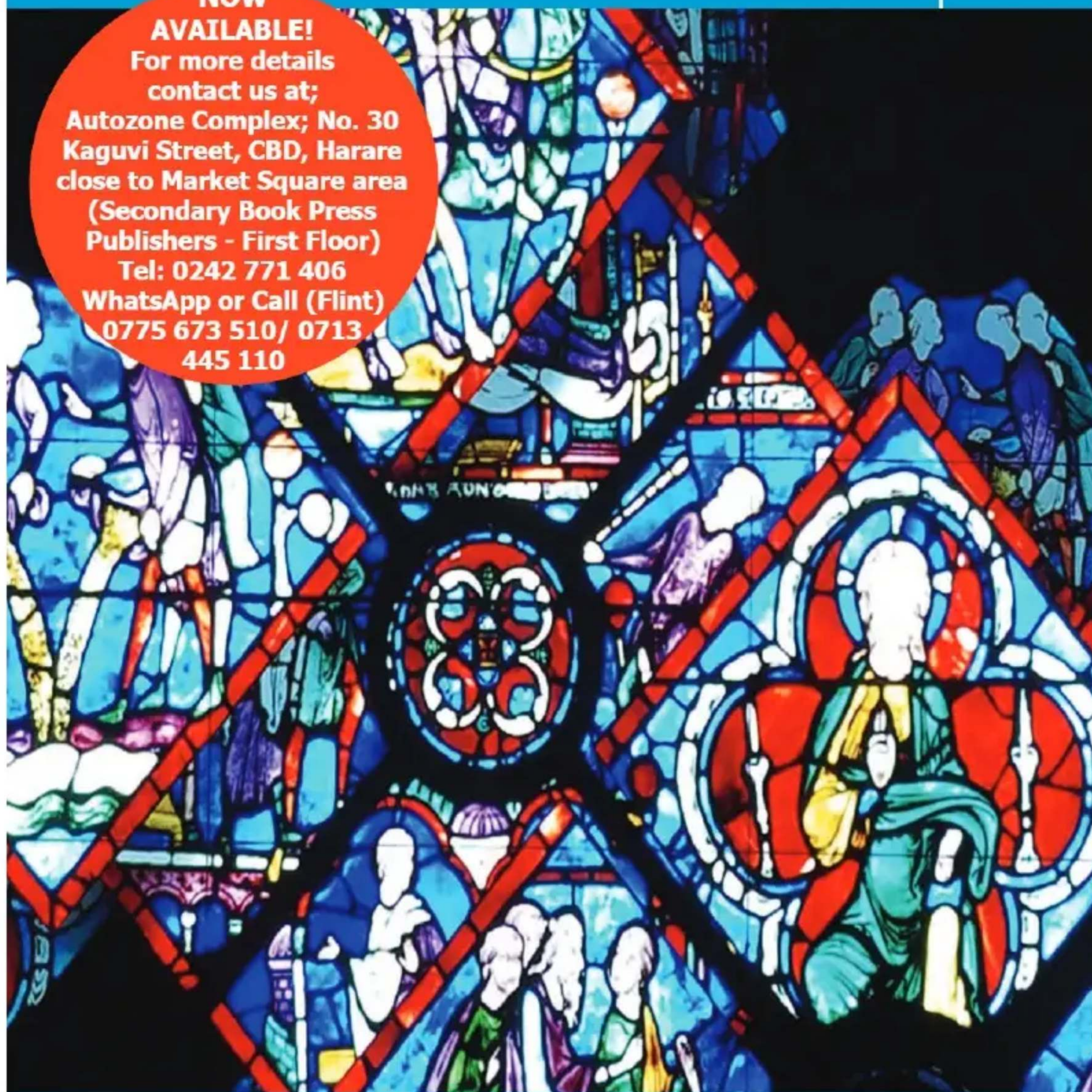
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A Practical Approach
to
Family and Religious Studies
Form 1

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Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter you should be able to:

- define religion.
- identify the types of religion.
- list characteristics of religion.

Introduction

The concept of religion includes feelings, beliefs and rituals that define the relationship between a Supreme Being and human beings. This chapter is going to introduce the concept of religion by first defining religion. After establishing the definition, the chapter will go on to identify different types of religion in the world and Zimbabwe in particular. The chapter will end by looking at the characteristics of religion. These characteristics will be discussed with the aid of examples, illustrating how they define religion and its unique attributes.

UNIT 1.1 DEFINITION AND TYPES OF RELIGION**Religion defined**

- Religion is defined as the belief in and worship of a supernatural being that control human destiny.
- Religion includes beliefs systems and practices that define the relationship between human beings and a Supreme Being.
- Religion is a set of beliefs, feelings, dogmas and practices that define the relations between human beings and sacred or divinity.
- A given religion is defined by specific elements of a community of believers such as dogmas, sacred books, rites, worship, sacraments, moral prescriptions, interdicts and organizations.
- Therefore, religion is defined by its major characteristics which include beliefs, religious practices, religious feeling and unity in a community of those who share the same faith.

Types of religion

There are different types of religions in the world. These are classified depending on their beliefs in God or gods and in relation to how they spread their faith to others.

1. **Monotheistic religions** - these religions are the ones that believe in one Supreme Being. Examples of monotheistic religions include Christianity, Judaism and Islam.
2. **Polytheistic religions** - these religions are the ones that believe in many gods. An example of a polytheistic religion is Hinduism.

In Indigenous religion, people believe that there is a Supreme Being who takes care of people in their daily experiences. Some religions believe in Supernatural Beings who are in the form of a spirit while others believe in some in physical forms.

2. Religious practitioners

There are different religious practitioners in different religions. Their names and roles differ from one religion to the religion. For instance, in Indigenous religion there are diviners, traditional healers and spirit mediums. In Christianity, there are practitioners who include Bishop, Pastor, Apostle, Prophet, Elders and Deacons who work in leading worship services. In Judaism there are practitioners who include Rabbis, Scribes and Priests. In Islam, there are religious practitioners who include Imam, Muezzin and Mujahideen. The religious practitioners in the different religions play different roles.



Fig. 1.1 Priest in Judaism

3. Rituals

Religion is also characterised with rituals. Various religions engage in different rituals at different stages of the religious life or cycle. However, these rituals are different across religions. Some rituals are carried out at specific places which are usually sacred like shrines. Rituals are meant to unite believers as well as actively involve them in the religious beliefs and practices. Rituals in various religions include circumcision, rain making ceremonies, rites of passage such as birth rites, marriage rites and death rites.

4. Moral code

Most religions in the world and Zimbabwe in particular have moral guidelines either in written form or oral. Since religions are usually practiced by many people, moral guidelines are a necessity in order to give directions on how individuals ought to behave and treat each other. Some of these guidelines originate from the Supreme Being indicating how people are expected to relate with their supernatural being. For instance, in Christianity the moral code is the Bible and most Christians believe in the Ten Commandments as the best guiding principles on how people are supposed to relate with their God and with fellow man. Judaism and Islam have their moral codes written in their sacred writings. The Shari'ah or Islamic law govern the behaviour of Muslims.

In Indigenous religion, moral guidelines are passed from generation to generation through oral tradition. It is also important to note that ethics or moral codes also help people on how to conduct rituals and ceremonies. Some religions and denominations have a binding constitution in order to sanction behaviour.

5. Prayer and other ways of communication

Prayer and other ways of communication are important characteristics of religion. This is because in most religions human beings seek to relate with their Supreme Being in a more personal way. Therefore, there is need for people to have a way of communicating with their God. For example, prayer is a major way of communication used between God and His people in Christianity, Islam and Judaism. People can talk to their God through prayer, either privately or publicly. In Indigenous religion, they make appeals to their Supreme God through ancestral spirits or spirit mediums. Therefore, religion is characterized by the existence of a mode of communication between believers and their supernatural being.

- Religions are characterized by rituals, symbols, sacraments and different ways of communicating with the Supreme Being.
- Religions are also characterised by trying to distinguish good things from bad things.
- Religious practitioners and founders also characterise religion.
- It is typical in many religions that believers are promised future hope. This can be through the coming of a new and better age, better existence in the afterlife or through coming of a redeemer.

Glossary of terms

Dogma	– a religious doctrine that is proclaimed as true without proof.
Ethics	– the standards or principles relating to right and wrong that govern the conduct of a person.
Monotheistic	– believing that there is only one God.
Omnipotent	– having unlimited power.
Omnipresent	– being present everywhere at once.
Omniscient	– infinitely wise.
Oral	– spoken by word of mouth as opposed to written.
Rituals	– a repeated set of actions.
Sacred	– set apart or dedicated for religious use hence not to be violated or profaned.
Talmud	– the collection of ancient rabbinic writings on Jewish law and tradition (the Mishna and the Gemara) that constitute the basis of religious authority in Orthodox Judaism.

Revision Exercises

True or False Questions

Answer the following by indicating whether each of the statements is either True or False

1. Religion is the belief in life after death.
2. There are only four types of religion in the world.
3. Christianity is monotheistic.
4. Christianity was founded on the life and teachings of Jesus Christ.
5. The society and religion have no connection at all.
6. Religious practitioners have the same names and roles all through religions.
7. Symbols are visible things that represent the invisible.
8. The Muslims' sacred text is called the Qur'an.
9. Religion distinguishes between the sacred and profane.
10. The most common characteristic of religion is the belief in Supernatural beings.

Multiple Choice Questions

1. Religion is _____.
 A. belief in and worship in a Supernatural Being B. belief in life after death
 C. monotheistic belief in one God D. belief in the teachings of Muhammad
2. Which are the most common and influential religions in the world?
 A. Christianity, Indigenous religion, Islam and Judaism.
 B. Christianity, Hinduism, Islam and Judaism.
 C. Christianity, Buddhism, Islam and Judaism.
 D. Christianity, Indigenous religion, Judaism and Hinduism.
3. Who is the founder of Islam?
 A. Jesus Christ B. Moses
 C. Muhammad D. Allah

4. Sacred scriptures in Judaism include the _____.
 A. Torah
 C. Qur'an
 B. Bible
 D. menorah
5. Which three religions believe in the one God?
 A. Indigenous religion Hinduism and Judaism
 C. Buddhism, Islam and Judaism
 B. Judaism, Christianity and Islam
 D. Indigenous religion, Buddhism and Christianity
6. The moral code for Christianity is _____.
 A. the Islamic law
 B. Torah
 C. rituals
 D. the Bible
7. _____ does not have a single founder.
 A. Islam
 B. Judaism
 C. Indigenous religion
 D. Christianity
8. Which religion does not have sacred scriptures?
 A. Indigenous religion
 B. Judaism
 C. Islam
 D. Christianity
9. The _____ symbolises light in Judaism.
 A. beads
 B. cross
 C. dome shape
 D. menorah
10. When believers break a moral code they feel a sense of _____.
 A. adoration
 B. joy
 C. guilt
 D. being thankful

Structured Questions

1. Moral guidelines give people a guide on how to behave and treated others.

- (a) Define ethics. [2]
- (b) Where do religions get their moral guidelines. [2]
- (c) State any three rules or ethics in Christianity. [3]
- (d) Describe the importance of moral ethics. [3]

2. Religion is the belief in a supernatural being.

- (a) Define beliefs. [2]
- (b) States any two religions and their major beliefs. [2]
- (c) Name any two characteristics of religion and explain them. [2]
- (d) What are the differences and similarities of Christianity and Indigenous religion beliefs. [4]

3. Religion is defined by its major characteristics.

- (a) Define religion. [1]
- (b) Name any two common characteristics of Islam. [4]
- (c) State any three religions that have common characteristics and name the characteristics. [3]
- (d) What is the importance of sacred texts in religion? [2]

Essay Questions

1. Identify and explain the characteristics of religion. [25]
2. Give notes on different types religions in Zimbabwe. [25]
3. Using examples give an explanation of the following characteristics of religion:
 - (a) Social organisation. [5]
 - (b) Sacred texts. [10]
 - (c) Symbols. [10]

Chapter objectives:

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- define Indigenous religion (IR).
- trace the historical background of Indigenous religion (IR).
- list names of the Supreme Being in Indigenous religion (IR).
- identify the attributes of the Supreme Being in Indigenous religion (IR).

Introduction

This chapter is going to define the term Indigenous religion and trace the historical backgrounds of Indigenous religion. In the historical backgrounds of the Indigenous religion, a consideration of the myths that explain the possible origins of the religion in Zimbabwe will be taken into account. In addition to that, the chapter further gives an outline of the names that the indigenous people give to their Supreme Being. Each name will be discussed in terms of meaning and finally the chapter identifies and discusses the attributes of the Supreme Being in Indigenous religion.

UNIT 2.1 HISTORICAL BACKGROUND OF INDIGENOUS RELIGION**Definition of Indigenous religion**

There are several definitions to Indigenous religion. It is made up of two significant words which are indigenous and religion. The word “indigenous” means something that is native to a particular geographical region. These include elements such as culture, languages, people and animal species. Indigenous refers to those elements which are not foreign or borrowed from other regions.

Considering the meaning of indigenous, Indigenous religion can be defined as:

- the religious practices which are native to a particular region. In Zimbabwe, it refers to the religious practices which have their roots in Zimbabwe and not from the outside world.
- a set of beliefs, feelings, dogmas and practices that define the relations between human beings and a sacred being that have their origins among the native people.

Historical background to Indigenous religion

Indigenous religion has no human founder. The origins of Indigenous religion are timeless and it is believed that the religion started with the origin of human civilization. Since Indigenous religion is a way of life, it is also believed to have started with the beginning of human kind. The origins of Indigenous religion date back to prehistoric time and little has been said and written about the history of the religion. Due to the fact

Interesting facts

1. Africans respect the environment because they are afraid of the ancestors.
2. Water spirits are easily irritated, especially by soap and metal objects.

Summary of the chapter

- Natural environment is made up of things that naturally occur underneath or on the earth's surface.
- Main components of natural environments are, land, water, forests, air and minerals.
- There are two types of resources, that is, renewable and non-renewable.
- Renewable resources do not get used up.
- Non-renewable resources are finite.
- Pollution is a process of making the environment unhealthy or impure.
- Littering is a form of both land and visual pollution.
- Air pollution is when air becomes impure.
- Sight/visual pollution includes all those things that do not appeal to the eye.
- Common soil erosions in Zimbabwe are due to wind and water.
- Ice erosion is rare in Africa because of hot temperatures.
- Deforestation is another cause of environmental degradation.
- Environment is a gift from the Supreme Being for some religions.
- Other religions see environment as a source of evil.
- The fear of the wrath of ancestors has resulted in environmental conservation among the people of Zimbabwe.
- People are just custodians of the environment and not proprietors.

Glossary of terms

Components	– parts or elements.
Degradation	– get lower in value or change for the worse.
Domestic	– of or relating to the home.
Eutrophication	– excessive nutrients in a lake or other water bodies usually caused by run off of fertilizers, animal waste or sewage from the land.
Forest	– the trees and other plants a large densely wooded area.
Foreign currency	– money from another country.
Infinite	– going on without end.
Mermaids	– half woman half fish believed to stay in water and has supernatural powers.
Pesticides	– chemicals used to kill pests.
Recycle	– cause to repeat a cycle.
Typhoid	– serious infection caused by inflammation of intestines.
Vegetation	– all plant life in a particular region.
Wildlife	– all living things that are undomesticated other than people.

Revision Exercises

True or False Questions

Answer the following by indicating whether each of the statements is either True or False.

1. Lakes are not part of the natural environment.
2. Water is a renewable resource.
3. Animal skins are used for making various religious items.
4. Human beings can use the environment in any way they want because it was created for them.

5. Some Christians use the natural space for worship.
6. There is no Biblical text which forbids Christians from eating certain type of meat.
7. Jews believe that God created man first then the environment last.
8. In Islam, Muslims are stewards of the natural environment.
9. All trees are sacred in Indigenous religion.
10. Mermaids reside in all the water bodies.

Multiple Choice Questions

1. Natural environment includes _____.
 A. buses
 B. cars
 C. birds
 D. aeroplanes
2. Which one is the main component of environment?
 A. Minerals
 B. Land
 C. Forests
 D. Wild animals
3. The Indigenous people of Zimbabwe respect the environment because _____.
 A. they love it
 B. it has been given to them by God
 C. it brings happiness
 D. they fear the ancestors who are the owners of the environment
4. When ancestors are angry, they _____.
 A. they bring prosperity and good health to the community
 B. they punish people either at individual or group level
 C. forgive all wrong doers
 D. leave the earth and go to heaven
5. What are believed to dwell in water?
 A. Mermaids spirits
 B. Alien spirits
 C. *Shave* spirits
 D. Wondering spirits
6. Stream bank cultivation refers to the practice of growing crops near _____.
 A. a wetlands, streams or rivers
 B. mountains
 C. resettled farms
 D. towns
7. Ice erosion is rare in Africa because _____.
 A. of very hot temperatures
 B. it is a continent of black people who follow indigenous religions
 C. ancestors
 D. ice is not of any religious significance
8. Erosion causes _____.
 A. gullies and dongas
 B. deforestation
 C. pollution
 D. anger in ancestral spirits.
9. Common erosion in Zimbabwe is due to _____.
 A. wind
 B. water
 C. ice
 D. construction
10. Which is not a taboo in Indigenous religion?
 A. Fetching water using a metal object.
 B. Cutting down a *muhacha* tree.
 C. Mass killing of wild animals
 D. Gathering dead wood for firewood

Structured Questions

1. Environmental damage is caused by many things.

- (a) Define natural environment. [2]
- (b) State any four elements which damages the environment. [2]
- (c) Explain the importance of the environment in Indigenous religion. [6]

2. Water pollution is a reality in Zimbabwean towns.

- (a) Define pollution. [2]
- (b) State the effects of pollution. [4]
- (c) Explain ways which Christians make use of the natural environment. [4]

3. Deforestation leads to environmental damage.

- (a) Define deforestation. [2]
- (b) Briefly explain the effects of deforestation. [8]

Essay Questions

- 1. Describe how the environment is preserved in the traditional Indigenous religion. [25]
- 2. Describe the causes of deforestation and the dangers associated with it in IR. [25]
- 3. Give notes on the use of water in Judaism. [25]

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- define rights.
- identify types of rights.
- define social responsibility.
- give different social responsibilities displayed at various levels.

Introduction

This chapter is about rights and social responsibilities. The two terms are going to be defined and described. The following examples of shared values on which rights are based will be described: fairness, dignity, equality respect and independence. Types of rights, namely, natural rights, moral rights, civil rights, political rights and socioeconomic rights are also going to be explained. Thereafter, forms of social responsibilities will be discussed. In particular are: philanthropic responsibility, environmental responsibility, ethical responsibility economic responsibility, legal responsibility and human rights responsibility.

UNIT 12.1 RIGHTS**Rights defined**

Rights are freedoms. Right is liberty each individual has. Rights are legal, social or ethical principles of freedom or entitlement. These are freedoms that belong to every person in the world from birth until death. A human right is any right or freedom to which all human beings are entitled and in whose exercise a government may not interfere.

(a) Dignity

Dignity involves calmness and seriousness of behaviour. A dignified youth is a treasure to the community. A dignified is respected because he or she has respect for others as well.

(b) Fairness

Fairness is about treating people equally. A fair youth does not treat people differently because they are poor, rich, beautiful, smart, intelligent or dull. He or she sees a person as a person. Fairness also involves treating people in the right way.

(f) Human rights responsibility

It is every person's right to respect other people's rights. There are freedoms that are set in the Declaration of Human Rights. These rights must not be infringed by anyone. It is deplorable to uphold one's rights and at the same time violating other peoples' rights. The individual person comes second to other individuals. While one is exercising his/her rights he/she must not abuse others because they have rights too.

Activity 12.2 Educational tour

Visit an old people's home or a children's home. Explain the things they need for their daily up keep. Present your findings to the class.

Exercise 12.2

1. Define social responsibility. [5]
2. Briefly explain the idea of philanthropic responsibility. [5]

Interesting facts

1. It is every person's right to respect other people's rights.
2. Rights are freedoms that inherent in every person.

Summary of the chapter

- Rights are legal, social principles of freedom.
- These freedoms are all people.
- Basic rights are based on shared rights.
- Education is a basic human right.
- Actions of an individual must benefit the whole community.
- Rights are legal, social and ethical principles of freedom.
- Freedoms belong to a person till death.
- Basic rights are based on shared values.
- Dignity involves calmness and serious behaviour.
- Fairness is about treating people equally.
- Independence is about all forms of freedoms.
- No one is free to harm others.
- Human rights are inherent in all human beings.
- A lot of people lost their lives to liberate others in Zimbabwe.
- Social responsibility is when individuals are accountable for fulfilling their civic rights.

Glossary of terms

Civic rights	– rights of citizens.
Chores	– a routine task especially household.
Constitution	– law of a country.
Fundamental	– something of central importance.
Government	– the organisation that is the governing authority of a political unit.
Independence	– freedom from control or influence of another or others.
Infrastructure	– the basic physical and organizational structures and facilities.
Infringement	– an act that disregards an agreement or right, a violation.
Patriotism	– profound love for one's country.
Philanthropy	– voluntary promotion of human welfare.
Voluntary	– work without payment.

Revision Exercises

True or False Questions

Answer the following by indicating whether each of the following statements is either True or False.

1. Dignity does not involve calmness and seriousness of behaviour
2. Fairness is about treating other people fairly.
3. Rights are not freedoms
4. Independence is about all forms of freedoms.
5. Natural rights are man-made.
6. Rights associated with copyrighted work are civil rights.
7. Discretionary responsibility is sometimes called philanthropic responsibility.
8. Behaving well at school is ethical responsibility.
9. It is a right not to respect other people's rights.
10. It is everyone's responsibility to respect other people's rights.

Multiple Choice Questions

1. Rights are freedoms that belong to every person from birth till _____.
A. adolescence
B. death
C. marriage
D. old age
2. Dignity involves what and seriousness of behaviour?
A. Calmness
B. Respect
C. Faith
D. Humility
3. Equality of people is based on _____.
A. what they own
B. where they live
C. what they eat
D. their humanness
4. Philanthropic responsibility is sometimes called _____ responsibility.
A. discretionary
B. environmental
C. political
D. civic
5. Ethical responsibility involves three things. Which one is not one of them?
A. The ability to appreciate values.
B. The ability to interpret values.
C. The ability to act upon values.
D. Taking part in the administration of the government.
6. Which responsibility involves how people use natural resources?
A. Civil
B. Political
C. Economic
D. Environmental
7. Shared values are protected by _____.
A. community
B. individuals
C. law
D. peers
8. Dignity is a treasure to _____.
A. self
B. community
C. God
D. church only
9. Moral rights are associated with _____.
A. personal liberty
B. liberty of opinion
C. liberty of worship
D. copyrighted work

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- define technology.
- give types of technology.
- explain how technology has benefited religious groups.
- define enterprise.
- assess enterprise in contemporary churches.

Introduction

This chapter is going to list and describe types of technology. The views of different religions on technology are also going to be described with the aid of examples. Enterprise is also going to be defined and described through the spectacles of various world religions. More attention shall be paid on enterprise in indigenous religion, namely the economic activities. The economic activities in Indigenous religion includes: trade, hunting, mining, craftwork, agriculture and livestock rearing.

UNIT 13.1 ENTERPRISE IN INDIGENOUS RELIGION**Enterprise defined**

Enterprise is a term which means entrepreneurship. It implies all forms of business. In simplest form, enterprise is trade. The major reason for having an enterprise is to trade and have money. Some people do business as individuals and others as a group. Enterprise is an organisation created for business ventures. It is the activity of providing goods and services involving financial and commercial and industrial aspects. Enterprise is sometimes called commercial exchange. It involves producing, buying and selling.

Types of enterprise

There are different types of enterprise in Zimbabwean societies. These different types of enterprise differ depending with the different religions here in Zimbabwe.

Enterprise in Indigenous religion

As has been pointed out before, indigenous religion is the way people live. It is their way of life. What the indigenous people do daily is religious. Every daily activity has to do with their religion. This implies that enterprises among the indigenous are part of the religion. There are several enterprises that were carried out before the advent of western civilization. There will be continuous to reference to this period

The sizes also determined their use. The smallest, *mbiya*, was used as a plate (today it is used by many for cleansing rituals). *Mbiya* is crushed at a crossroad so that one is cleansed from alien spirits or bad luck. *Hadyana* was used for cooking relish, a *tsambakodzi* was used for cooking *sadza* or pap, a *pfuko* was for millet drink (*maheu*), *chirongo* was meant for storing water and *gate* was designed for storing beer. All these items were religious objects. When produced in excess, they were traded. There were also specialists in the area of craftwork.

(vi) Trading

Trade was one of the major economic activities among the indigenous people of Zimbabwe. They barter traded among themselves and with foreigners. They traded grain, meat, hides, hoes, axes, knives, various iron tools, gold, and ivory. In the end they paid tribute for selling. This was done to appease the ancestors so that they keep on blessing them.

Enterprise in Christianity

Christian religions have two extreme positions on enterprise. For some, it is a good idea to be in business and make money. This understanding is based on the Old Testament teaching that it is a blessing from God to be rich. For others, it is a curse to have more than one needs in life because being rich is a pathway to hell. The Christians base their understanding on Jesus' teaching on beatitudes. Jesus declared that the only people who are blessed were the poor and not the rich. The poor would go to heaven. The rich are destined for hell since it is easier for a camel to enter through the eye of a needle than a rich man to enter the kingdom of heaven. According to Christian understanding, it is impossible for a rich man to go to heaven.

There are Christians who see poverty as a curse. They see wealth and prosperity as blessing. They end up doing anything possible to gain more riches. Forming a church today, for example, has become a profit-making enterprise on its own. Self-proclaimed prophets have founded churches and are making millions of money from unsuspecting converts. Churches are being formed today not for the purpose of saving souls but for self-enrichment. It is now business. This is common among Pentecostal and Independent Churches.

Some churches are making money, other than from members' contributions, by selling anointed oil, water, bricks, pens, wrist bands, clothing, oranges and other items at very high prices. Some churches make their members even buy seats during services. The more one pays, the closer that person sits to the pulpit preacher or prophet. Other churches engage in real business to keep them going. They have many schools, hospitals and farms across the country from which they get money. These are mission schools, mission farms and mission hospitals. They offer services to the public and the public pay for the services.

Enterprise in Judaism

Like Christianity, Judaism preaches the gospel of prosperity. In Judaism it is a curse from Yahweh to be poor. Riches and wealth are a blessing from above. Only the upright were blessed with prosperity. Sinners were doomed and whatever they owned did not multiply. This is why the poor were despised in the Jewish community. However, some prophets, like Hosea, denounced those who abused the poor. Generally, poverty was a curse. With time most Jews became very rich. They became entrepreneurs. Today Jews value wealth and understand it as God given.

Enterprise in Islam

In Islam, there is nothing negative towards accumulation of wealth. The founder of Islam was a merchant, a trader who worked for a rich widow called Kadijah. Kadijah later became his wife. His name was Muhammad. He acquired most of his wealth by way laying caravans and carrying out *ridar* wars. Many Muslims today

engage in trade. Poverty is an anathema in Islam. Being rich is also a blessing. However, they are expected to give part of their wealth to the poor as one of the five pillars of Islam emphasise works of charity. Muslims, today, are ranked high on the international trade. They have oil and oil drilling is the hub of their economy.

Activity 13.1 Discussion

'It is hard for a camel to enter through the needle's eye than a rich man to enter the kingdom of God.' Why do you think this statement is false with regard to some new churches in Zimbabwe?

Exercise 13.1

1. Define enterprise. [2]
2. Briefly explain the types of enterprise. [15]

UNIT 13.2 TECHNOLOGY

Technology defined

Technology has been defined in many ways. Some of the definitions are below. Technology has been defined as the use of knowledge to invent new devices or tools. Invention is the key word in this definition. Each society has its own type of technology. This explains away the view that Zimbabweans had no technology before the arrival of western civilization.

The people of Zimbabwe had their own inventions which are going to be look at later. In some circles, technology has been given as science of craft, art or skill or cunning of hands. The main word in this definition is hand. This implies that, above all, there is the use of hands. Technology is therefore, practical. It has tangible results. Another definition is that technology is the application of scientific knowledge to the practical aims of human life. It is a field of knowledge having to do with the practical applications of science. Technology is, therefore, scientific. In a nut shell, technology is the use of scientific knowledge to create tools.

Types of technology

It has been said that technology is all about new inventions. There are many inventions that take place today on daily basis. There is always a new car, a new phone, a new computer, a new something. The list can go on and on. Technology is never static, it evolves minute by minute. It is, therefore, not possible to list down all types of inventions. Below are some types of technology. Some of the technologies are going to be briefly explained below and more attention will be on information technology for it has benefitted religion in one way or another more than other forms of technology.

(a) Mechanical Technology

Mechanical technology involves things that turn or allow motion in one direction. All such things are said to be mechanical. Examples of mechanical technology are wheels, levers, belts or engines.

(b) Information Technology

This is a broad class of technology based on machines that process data and perform calculations at high speed. Computers are examples of such machines. Such machines work with networks as well. Networks are links that allow devices to share data. When networks are connected, they form larger networks. These larger networks are called internet. Information technology is of great value to religion.

Assistive	– giving assistance.
Barter trade	– trading without the use of money.
Enterprise	– a business or company.
Medical practitioners	– doctors, nurses or herbalists.
Tangible	– that which can be touched or seen.
Technology	– the practical application of science.
Foreigners	– people who are not native.

Revision Exercises

True or False Questions

Answer the following by indicating whether each of the following statements is either True or False.

1. Enterprise means entrepreneurship.
2. Enterprise is religious in Indigenous religion.
3. Livestock in IR is for rituals only.
4. Or Christians, it is evil to be very rich.
5. For Jews, poverty is not a curse.
6. In Islam, being rich is not a bad thing.
7. Each society has its own type of technology.
8. Churches spread the gospel through information technology.
9. IT is of little value in Indigenous religion.
10. Technology is tangible, practical and has results.

Multiple Choice Questions

1. The main purpose of an enterprise is to _____.
 A. to make money
 B. be famous
 C. do works of charity
 D. use ecocash for business
2. Indigenous religion is _____.
 A. an evangelical religion
 B. a way of life for the indigenous people
 C. a branch of Christianity
 D. a false religion
3. The indigenous people of Zimbabwe got ivory from _____.
 A. mines
 B. small animals
 C. elephants
 D. the animals they trapped
4. What determined the use of baskets and clay pots?
 A. Shape and size
 B. Colour
 C. The material used
 D. Density
5. The main form of trade among the indigenous people of Zimbabwe was _____.
 A. barter trade
 B. trading among themselves
 C. trading with foreigners
 D. trading using money
6. The indigenous people were believed to be what before the coming of the Europeans?
 A. Innovative
 B. Producers of tools
 C. Without technology
 D. A people of great inventions
7. Wheels, levers, belts and engines are examples of which technology?
 A. Information
 B. Medical
 C. Transport
 D. Industrial

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- narrate the background of the liberation struggle.
- identify forms of liberation.
- identify causes of the liberation struggle.
- explain the causes of the liberation struggle.
- identify religious groups involved in the liberation struggle.
- explain the role of religious groups involved in the liberation struggle.

Introduction

This chapter is going to discuss the background of the liberation struggle in Zimbabwe. The background covers the process of colonisation up until the end of the First *Chimurenga/Umvukela*. Thereafter, causes and course of the struggle shall be explained. The role churches and indigenous religions shall be explained.

UNIT 14.1 BACKGROUND OF THE LIBERATION STRUGGLE

Liberation is a term which connotes freedom. A liberation struggle is a struggle which attempts to achieve equal rights or status. A Shona word for liberation is *Chimurenga* which means *Umvukela* in Ndebele. The liberation struggle in Zimbabwe was fought between the White settlers and the Black people of Zimbabwe.

Forms of the liberation struggle

Liberation has two types. There is liberation that does not involve violence. This type of liberation is known as non-violent liberation. The other type of liberation involves violence. This is called violent liberation.

1. Non-violent Liberation

This type of liberation is very peaceful in nature. This means that this form of liberation has no loss of life. No one dies and no one gets hurt physically. The oppressed voice is heard through non-violent means. The oppressed convey their message by carrying out demonstrations, strikes or sabotaging. Non-violent liberation also includes negotiations between the characters involved. Agreement is arrived at peacefully.

2. Violent liberation

Violent liberation struggle is lethal in nature. A violent struggle involves loss of the people we love. People die. Some are left with disabilities. Others are raped in the presence of their family members. This type of

liberation is not better than non-violent liberation. It includes use of all deadly weapons like chemicals, atomic bombs, nuclear weapons, poisonous gases and cluster bombs. This type of liberation involves war. War can be in form of biological warfare, chemical warfare, nuclear warfare and so forth.

Of the two forms of liberation struggle, Zimbabwe took the middle path. The pathway adopted was both peaceful and violent at the same time. It was violent in that the people engaged in an armed struggle. The struggle left many people dead, lame, homeless and without parents. The struggle was peaceful in that independence was gained through negotiations. The warring parties engaged in a peaceful dialogue at Lancaster house. The agreement brought an end to bloodshed and suffering of civilians.

Background of the First Chimurenga

Europe developed faster than all of the African countries industrially. European countries wanted to expand their territories in search of raw materials. They went as far as America and Australia. They also came to Africa where they began to grab territories. European countries came to Africa because they needed markets for their finished goods and to mine gold and diamonds. They also wanted land for farming, wild animals and cheap labour. These countries, therefore, had every reason to colonise Africa. It was after the Berlin Conference (1884-85) that Europeans competed for areas of influence in Africa. From the west of Zimbabwe came the Germans, from the south were the British and the Portuguese were coming from the east. They all wanted to colonize Zimbabwe. It was Rhodes who led the colonisation of Zimbabwe. He had several reasons for doing this.

The above reasons saw the signing of treaties in Zimbabwe. Most of the treaties were signed between the settlers and Lobengula. Lobengula was the ruler of the Ndebele people who had just occupied the eastern part of the country. They had run away from Tshaka the Zulu during Mfecane. The Ndebele came with Mzilikazi who already had settler friends before he came to Zimbabwe. The treaties signed included the London-Limpopo treaty (1870), Baines treaty (1871), Grobler treaty (1887), Moffat treaty (1888), Rudd Concession (1888) and Lippert Concession (1891). It was the signing of these treaties that saw the advent of the invading column. The invading column came under the leadership Rhodes. When the Pioneers came, they divided the country into districts, sold land, built houses and towns, churches, schools and hospitals. They also mined and farmed. The settlers used forced labour in achieving all this. People were disgruntled.

Therefore the coming of the whites marked a great shift in the lives of the indigenous people. Life did not change for the better but for the worse. There were many grievances among the black population that were triggered by colonisation. Colonial rule was harsh and very hostile to both Shona and the Ndebele people. Causes of the First Chimurenga included loss of fertile land, cattle, sheep and goats, forced labour, taxes (namely, hut tax, poll tax, cattle tax and dip tax), abuse of women, police brutality, loss of power and natural disasters.

Activity 14.1 Debate

Debate ofn the claim that, "Non-violent liberation struggle is the best way to solve all the discontentments."

Exercise 14.1

1. Explain the background of the First Chimurenga.

[8]

of hope (whites will be driven out). They assumed a commanding role in the struggle. They also influenced fighters to expect supernatural powers from Mwari. Spirit mediums communicated with the ancestors and controlled political leaders where there were wrong. During then war they treated the wounded and buried the dead fighters away from home. They also carried out all the necessary rituals during burial and reburial of fighters. Above all, they mobilized people to fight. The parents' major role was to feed the guerillas. They also gave them blankets and clothes. Mujibhas and Zvimbwidos, on the other hand, carried weapons for the guerillas. They also spied for the fighters and washed their clothes. The chiefs were responsible for receiving the guerillas in their areas. The workers in rural areas and the business community helped by giving money, clothes, food and cigarettes. The liberation struggle involved nearly everyone save for those who sold out and worked for the enemy.

Christianity and the liberation struggle

Generally, Christianity ran with the hare and hunted with the hounds during the struggle. It preached the gospel of the oppressed, preached about equality, human rights, freedom of individuals and love of neighbour. The Christian churches assisted with education and rendered health care to liberation fighters. At the same time, they taught that it was a mortal sin to revolt against the government because the government was put in place by the creator. This teaching was based on Paul's letter to the Roman in which he wanted to repress revolts which were looming during his time (Romans 13:1-7).

However, the gist of his message was that people must remain loyal to the government. This implied that the liberation struggle was morally wrong because it was about fighting a government that was put in place by God. Christians also preached the gospel of forgiveness, encouraging the giving of the other cheek after being slapped the other. It was God's duty to punish those who wrong others.

In Zimbabwe, mainline churches played a bigger role during the Second Chimurenga. They supported total liberation of the indigenous black people who had lived under oppression since the coming of settlers. The Catholic Church championed in fighting for the liberation of Zimbabweans. The Church, through its commission of peace and justice lobbied for equality among Zimbabweans, so, equality before the law, equal education and health facilities. They also fought for basic human rights for blacks. The Catholic Council of Bishops worked hand in glove with freedom fighters in Mozambique and those who were already on the battle front. The clergy (priests, brothers and nuns) supported the liberation by either joining the war of liberation. The Catholic Church provided medication, food, clothes and education to freedom fighters. At independence in 1980, the Catholic Bishop Patrick Chakaipa officiated the ceremony. This church is still working with the government today.

The Methodist Church also took a leading role in the Second Chimurenga. The church did this through writing articles against the white regime. Rev Canaan Banana was an outstanding Bishop of this church who wrote books against oppression of the black people. This earned a good job at Independence as the first President of Zimbabwe. The Anglican Church also tirelessly fought tooth and nail for the liberation of Zimbabweans. The church teamed up with other churches in de-campaigning the oppressors at home and abroad. The church added value to the struggle.

African Independent Churches were formed to preach against colonizers. These included the Zion Christian Church (ZCC) of Samuel Mutendi, Johanne Marange, African Apostolic Churches, African Apostolic Church led by Paul Mwazha and many others. These churches preached vehemently against colonisation. They supported the struggle in various ways. They prayed for the fighters in the bush and recruited young men and women to join the struggle. They also motivated the fighters and provided with food and clothing. These churches gave fighters medicines, shelter and blankets. They protected the fighters by foretelling what was imminent. They did laundry and many other things that appeared small but very important. By and large, religious groups assisted spiritually and materially. No church can be singled out that it did not support the struggle.

Revision Exercises

True or False Questions

Answer the following by indicating whether each of the following statements is either True or False.

1. Liberation is a term that connotes freedom.
2. Non-violent form of liberation is lethal in nature.
3. European countries wanted raw materials in Zimbabwe.
4. Treaties were signed between Mzilikazi and the British with the help of the Shona.
5. The main cause of Chimurenga was loss of land the belonged to ancestors.
6. Missionaries condemned IR as devilish and evil.
7. Spirit mediums assisted in the liberation struggles.
8. Christians supported both warring parties during the liberation struggle.
9. The Methodist Church assisted during the 2nd Chimurenga with the help of Canaan Banana who later became the first president of Zimbabwe.
10. African independent Churches were formed to preach against colonialism.

Multiple Choice Questions

1. For the indigenous people, colonizers brought change _____.
A. life changed for the better
B. life became worse
C. there was no change at all
D. people had good life
2. The most important commodity that was taken by colonizers.
A. Forests
B. Land
C. Wildlife
D. Mines
3. There was one place where people were not forced to work _____.
A. farm
B. church
C. mine
D. industry
4. Which of the following did the colonizers not ask for tax?
A. Cattle
B. Dip
C. Hut
D. Chicken
5. What ended with the coming of colonizers?
A. Barter trade with the Portuguese.
B. Paying tribute.
C. Paying taxes.
D. Growing of indigenous crops.
6. In the first Chimurenga, how many fronts did colonizers fight?
A. Two
B. Three
C. Four
D. Five
7. Prior the coming of colonizers, how were the relations between Shona and Ndebele people?
A. Sour
B. Good
C. Friendly
D. Loving
8. Who inspired the Shona in the first Chimurenga?
A. Nehanda and Kaguvi
B. Karigamombe
C. Indunas
D. Missionaries
9. After the first Chimurenga, two chiefs continued to resist _____.
A. Mapondera and Nyandoro
B. Nehanda and Kuguvi
C. Mashayamombe and Svosve
D. Mangwende and Mukwati
10. Which one is not part of violent liberation?
A. Ammunition
B. Chemical weapons
C. Injury
D. Sabotage

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